

Software Installation & Licensing Policy

1. Purpose

This policy establishes rules for requesting, installing, licensing, and managing software on Summit IT Services endpoints and systems. Unauthorized or unlicensed software introduces security vulnerabilities, compliance risk, and legal liability. Only approved software, distributed through IT-managed channels, may be installed on company devices.

2. Scope

This policy applies to:

- All software installed on company-owned or company-managed devices, including Windows 11 laptops (Dell Latitude 7440), macOS laptops (MacBook Pro 14"), and company-issued mobile devices.
- All cloud-based SaaS applications purchased or used with company resources or on behalf of Summit IT Services.
- All employees, contractors, and temporary staff with access to company devices.
- Open-source software, freeware, shareware, browser extensions, scripts, and developer tools are included in scope.

3. Policy Statements

3.1 Approved Software Distribution Channels

3.1.1 Windows devices: All approved software is available through the **Company Portal** application, deployed and managed by Microsoft Intune. Employees may install pre-approved applications from Company Portal without a request ticket.

3.1.2 macOS devices: All approved software is available through the **Self Service** application, deployed and managed by Jamf Pro. Employees may install pre-approved applications from Self Service without a request ticket.

3.1.3 Software not available in Company Portal or Self Service may be requested through SummitDesk using the "Software Request" catalog item. Requests are reviewed by L2 Desktop & Systems within 3 business days.

3.1.4 The IT-approved software catalog is published and maintained at <https://help.summitit.com/catalog/software>. Employees should check the catalog before submitting a new software request.

3.2 Prohibited Installation Methods

3.2.1 Employees must not install software by any of the following methods without IT approval:

Prohibited Method	Reason
Downloading installers from the internet directly	Risk of malware, tampered installers
Running .exe, .pkg, .dmg files received via email or Slack	High phishing/trojan vector
Installing browser extensions not on the approved list	Data exfiltration risk
Using package managers (npm, pip, brew, winget) to install system-level tools	Unvetted dependencies; license risk
Side-loading mobile apps	Malware risk; MDM policy violation
Enabling developer mode on managed devices without approval	Bypasses security controls

3.2.2 Developer tools (IDEs, language runtimes, SDKs, CLI tools) for employees in engineering roles may be installed through approved package managers (Homebrew on macOS, winget on Windows) only after a blanket approval is granted for the employee's role via SummitDesk. Each tool must still be individually listed in the employee's approved tool request.

3.2.3 Local administrator rights are not granted to standard end users. Software installations requiring elevation are processed through Intune/Jamf-managed deployment or by an L2 Desktop technician.

3.3 SaaS and Cloud Application Procurement

3.3.1 **Shadow IT is prohibited.** Employees must not sign up for, purchase, or use SaaS applications using personal credit cards or expense reimbursement for business data processing without IT and Finance approval. This includes free-tier cloud services used for company data (e.g., personal Dropbox, consumer ChatGPT, free Notion accounts for company projects).

3.3.2 All new SaaS applications must go through the **IT Vendor Review Process** before procurement:

1. Employee submits a "New SaaS Application Request" via SummitDesk.
2. IT Security conducts a security review (SOC 2 report, data processing terms, SSO compatibility).
3. Legal reviews data processing agreement (DPA) if the application will process personal data.
4. Finance approves budget.
5. IT provisions the application via Okta SSO and configures appropriate access controls.

3.3.3 SaaS applications that process Confidential or Restricted data must support Okta SSO and must not allow individual employee sign-up without IT provisioning. This is enforced via Okta application access controls and Conditional Access policies.

3.3.4 Approved SaaS applications are integrated with Okta for provisioning and de-provisioning. Employee accounts in approved SaaS tools are automatically deactivated within 4 hours of offboarding.

3.4 Software Licensing

3.4.1 All software used at Summit IT Services must be properly licensed. Employees must not:

- Use software beyond the scope of its license (e.g., using a personal subscription for company work, exceeding seat count).
- Copy, share, or distribute licensed software to unlicensed parties.
- Remove or disable license enforcement mechanisms, DRM, or watermarks.

3.4.2 Software license management is maintained by IT in the asset management system. License compliance audits are conducted annually. Employees must not purchase individual software licenses without IT coordination, as duplicate or non-standard licenses create audit risk.

3.4.3 **Open-source software (OSS)** used in production systems or client deliverables must be reviewed for license compatibility (e.g., GPL viral licenses). OSS used on company devices for personal productivity (e.g., VLC) must be downloaded only from official project sources. Engineering teams using OSS in code must follow the Software Development & Open Source Policy (separate document).

3.4.4 Trial or evaluation software licenses must be tracked in SummitDesk and must not be continued past the evaluation period without a formal purchase approval.

3.5 Security Requirements for Approved Software

3.5.1 All software deployed via Intune or Jamf is:

- Scanned for malware by CrowdStrike Falcon during deployment.
- Sourced from vendor-signed packages only.
- Deployed with least-privilege configurations where possible.

3.5.2 Software must be kept up to date. Critical security patches for approved applications must be applied within **14 days** of release. Intune and Jamf enforce automatic updates for most managed applications.

3.5.3 Software that has reached vendor end-of-life (EOL) must be removed from company devices within **60 days** of EOL date unless a formal exception and compensating controls are approved.

3.5.4 Employees must not disable or remove software update mechanisms for any application.

3.6 Browser Extensions

3.6.1 Browser extensions must be installed only from the IT-approved extension list published at <https://help.summitit.com/catalog/extensions>.

3.6.2 Extensions with "read and change all your data on all websites" permissions require L2 Desktop approval before installation, regardless of whether they are in the approved list.

3.6.3 Unapproved extensions discovered on managed devices will be removed by Intune/Jamf policy without notice.

3.7 Software Removal

3.7.1 Employees must not uninstall security software (CrowdStrike Falcon, Okta Verify, GlobalProtect, Intune Company Portal, Jamf agent) under any circumstances.

3.7.2 Employees who no longer need a piece of software may uninstall it via Company Portal or Self Service. If they cannot remove it, submit a SummitDesk request.

3.7.3 IT reserves the right to remotely uninstall any unauthorized software from managed devices without advance notice.

4. Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
All Employees	Use only approved software; submit requests via SummitDesk; report unauthorized software discovered on their device
Managers	Approve software requests for their team; ensure team awareness of this policy
IT Service Desk (L1)	Accept and route software requests; answer catalog questions
L2 Desktop & Systems	Review and fulfill software requests; manage Company Portal and Self Service catalogs; enforce removals
IT Security & Compliance	Conduct security reviews of new software; perform license audits; own this policy
L3 Engineering	Maintain Intune/Jamf software deployment pipelines; configure auto-update policies; integrate SaaS apps with Okta
Legal	Review DPAs for new SaaS applications; advise on license compliance
Finance	Approve software purchases; manage vendor contracts

5. Enforcement & Consequences

5.1 Intune and Jamf enforce application blocklists and automatically remove unauthorized software. CrowdStrike Falcon quarantines potentially malicious files on download.

5.2 Policy violations:

- **Installing unapproved software (first occurrence):** Software removed; written warning; mandatory security training.
- **Repeated unauthorized installation:** Formal HR action; local admin request permanently denied.

- **Using unlicensed software:** Software removed; potential financial liability for license remediation costs; HR action.
- **Shadow IT SaaS (processing company data in unapproved services):** Data recovery required; formal written warning; potential HR action depending on data sensitivity.
- **Deliberate circumvention of installation controls:** Immediate access restriction; HR/Legal investigation.

6. Exceptions

Software exceptions (e.g., a unique tool required for a client project that isn't in the catalog) must be submitted via SummitDesk. Exceptions require:

1. Business justification and description of the software.
2. IT Security review (SOC 2, CVE history, permissions review).
3. Manager and IT Security approval.
4. Time-bounded exception (maximum 90 days pending full catalog inclusion).

7. Related Documents

- POL-001 - Acceptable Use Policy
- POL-005 - Data Classification & Handling Policy
- POL-009 - Access Control & Least Privilege Policy
- POL-010 - IT Asset Management Policy
- REF-0001 - Summit IT Environment Standards
- Approved Software Catalog (<https://help.summitit.com/catalog/software>)
- SaaS Vendor Review Process (internal wiki)

8. Revision History

Version	Date	Author	Summary of Changes
1.0	2021-07-01	IT Security	Initial policy
2.0	2023-01-15	IT Security & Compliance	Added SaaS procurement process; shadow IT clause; browser extension rules
2.1	2024-05-01	IT Security & Compliance	Added developer tools carve-out; EOL software remediation timeline; updated package manager rules

2.2	2025-08-20	IT Security & Compliance	Annual review; aligned Okta SaaS de-provisioning timeline with offboarding policy
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